

YEAR 9 · THEME 6 · LIFE IN THE CITY & COUNTRY

Reading

B1.1

The Balıkesir Street Food Festival · My Grandmother's Stuffed Peppers

9. Sınıf

Name – Surname

Class

No

Date

Aim Understand the main idea and details, make inferences and connect the text to your own life.

1 Before you read

Make predictions before you read.

1. Look at the title. What kind of food do you think you can find at a street food festival?

2. Guess: what three things might people do at a food festival?

The Balıkesir Street Food Festival

- 1 Every September, our town holds the Balıkesir Street Food Festival, and it's one of my favourite weekends of the year. Dozens of food stalls line the main square, and the smell of grilled sweetcorn and spicy sauces fills the air.
- 2 This year, my family is trying food from five different countries. At one stall, a vendor is making fresh falafel with chickpeas, herbs and a squeeze of lemon. At another, a woman is grilling Turkish pizza — thin, crispy and topped with minced meat and vegetables.
- 3 My little brother always asks the same Wh-question at every stall: 'What's in this dish?' He loves sweetcorn with cream and cheese, and he doesn't stop eating it until it's finished! I prefer something spicier, so I usually order falafel or a stuffed pepper.
- 4 The festival isn't only about eating, though. There's live music, a cooking competition, and a stage where local chefs show their family recipes to the crowd. Right now, a famous local chef is demonstrating how to make a traditional dessert with homemade cream.
- 5 By the end of the day, we are all full, happy and a little bit sleepy. For me, the best part of the festival is trying a new flavour every year — and finding out which local specialty I like best.

214 words

2 While you read

6 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

1. What is the text mainly about?
☐ a A cooking competition on TV ☐ b A street food festival in the writer's town
☐ c A trip to another country
 2. What is the writer's brother's favourite food at the festival?
☐ a Falafel ☐ b Sweetcorn with cream and cheese ☐ c Turkish pizza
 3. What does the writer usually order?
☐ a Something spicy, like falafel or a stuffed pepper ☐ b Only sweetcorn ☐ c Only dessert
 4. What is happening at the festival right now, according to the text?
☐ a A local chef is demonstrating a dessert recipe ☐ b Everyone is going home
☐ c The vendors are closing their stalls
 5. The festival only has food stalls — there's nothing else to do. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
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6. Why does the writer say the festival is her favourite weekend?
☐ a Because she doesn't like her town ☐ b Because she enjoys trying new food and flavours every year
☐ c Because school is closed

3 After you read*Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.*

1. If your town held a street food festival, which dish would you want to try first? Why?

2. Write two sentences describing what a vendor at the festival might be doing right now.

1 Before you read*Make predictions before you read.*

1. What do you think 'stuffed peppers' means? Guess the ingredients.

2. Do you have a special family recipe? Think of one dish.

My Grandmother's Stuffed Peppers

- 1 In my family, Sunday lunch always means one thing: my grandmother's stuffed peppers. It's a traditional recipe that she learned from her own mother, and now she's teaching it to me, step by step.
- 2 This morning, we are preparing the ingredients together in her kitchen. She is washing the peppers while I am chopping onions, tomatoes and fresh herbs. 'What do we add next?' I ask her, and she always answers with a smile: 'A little rice, a little love.'
- 3 My grandmother says every family has its own version of this dish — some add sweetcorn, some use different spices, and some make it spicier than others. Ours isn't very spicy, but it's full of flavour, with rice, herbs and a spoonful of cream on top.
- 4 While the peppers are cooking slowly in the oven, we sit at the table and my grandmother tells stories about her own childhood. She often asks me Wh-questions like 'Do you prefer this dish or your mother's soup?' — and I honestly can't choose!
- 5 When the stuffed peppers are finally ready, the whole house smells delicious. For me, this homemade meal isn't only about the taste — it's about spending time with my grandmother and keeping our family's recipe alive for the next generation.

210 words

2 While you read

6 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

1. What is this text mainly about?
 - ☐ a A restaurant review
 - ☐ b A family tradition of cooking stuffed peppers together
 - ☐ c A trip to a food festival
 2. Who is the writer cooking with?
 - ☐ a A friend
 - ☐ b Her grandmother
 - ☐ c A professional chef
 3. What is the writer doing while her grandmother washes the peppers?
 - ☐ a Chopping onions, tomatoes and herbs
 - ☐ b Watching TV
 - ☐ c Setting the table
 4. What does the family add to make the dish full of flavour but not too spicy?
 - ☐ a Extra chili
 - ☐ b Rice, herbs and cream
 - ☐ c Only sweetcorn
 5. The writer's grandmother never talks while they cook. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
-
6. Why is this meal special to the writer, according to the last paragraph?
 - ☐ a Because it is the cheapest meal she knows
 - ☐ b Because it connects her to her grandmother and family tradition
 - ☐ c Because it takes the least time to cook

3 After you read

Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.

1. Do you have a recipe that is special in your family? Describe it in two sentences.

2. Write one Wh-question you could ask a grandparent about a family recipe.
